Inflationary Pressures and Livelihood Resilience Among Fruit Vendors in Mumbai's Informal Sector

FIELD PROJECT REPORT

B.A.

Semester : VI

Course Code: UAECO05501FP1

Name of the Student : Jonathan Flettin Marattukalam

UID NO: 2301444

ROLL NO: 101

Under the Guidance of

Dr. Aparna Kulkarni



St. Xavier's College
(Empowered Autonomous Institute) 5,
Mahapalika Marg
Mumbai – 400 001

Academic Year: 2025-26



DEPARTMENT OF Economics
ST. XAVIER'S COLLEGE, MUMBAI
(EMPOWERED AUTONOMOUS INSTITUTE)

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that Mr./Ms. _____,a student of St. Xavier's college, Mumbai, has successfully completed a project titled "Inflationary Pressures and Livelihood Resilience Among Fruit Vendors in Mumbai's Informal Sector" under the Department of Economics for the Academic Year 2025–2026. To the best of my knowledge, the work submitted by the student is original, and the information presented in the project is accurate and authentic.

Internal Guide Head of the Department

DEPARTMENT OF Economics
ST. XAVIER'S COLLEGE, MUMBAI
(EMPOWERED AUTONOMOUS INSTITUTE)

DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the Field Project titled "Inflationary Pressures and Livelihood Resilience Among Fruit Vendors in Mumbai's Informal Sector", submitted by me as part of the Field Project requirement for the B.A. / B.Sc. / B.Com. (Third / Fourth Year) programme of St. Xavier's College (Autonomous), Mumbai, is my original work carried out under the guidance of Dr. Aparna Kulkarni. I further declare that this work has not been submitted to any other institution or university for the award of any Degree, Diploma, Certificate, or similar academic qualification. All sources of information have been properly acknowledged in the report.

AI-Use & Academic Integrity Statement:
I affirm that the Field Project Report submitted by me is an original piece of work based on my own field observations, data collection, analysis, and interpretation. I take full responsibility for the authenticity and academic integrity of the content presented. I further declare that no generative AI tools were used to write, analyse, or paraphrase the substantive content of this report. If any AI tools were used, their role was strictly limited to grammar checks, formatting assistance, or idea clarification, without influencing the originality of the work.
I also confirm that all field activities were carried out in accordance with the ethical guidelines of St. Xavier's College, including norms for conducting research involving human participants. Informed consent was obtained wherever required, and care was taken to ensure confidentiality, respect, safety, and responsible data handling.
I understand that any breach of academic integrity or ethical conduct may result in penalties as per College regulations.

Name of Student: Jonathan Flettin Marattukalam
UID No.: 2301444
Roll No.: 101
Department: Economics

Signature of Student
Date: 22/06/2026
Place: Mumbai



ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to Dr. Aparna Kulkarni for her guidance and support throughout this project. Her insights into development economics helped shape the direction of this research. I am also grateful to the fruit vendors at Crawford Market and Byculla Market who generously gave their time to participate in the interviews, without whom this project would not have been possible.

Inflationary Pressures and Livelihood Resilience Among Fruit Vendors in Mumbai's Informal Sector

A Microeconomic Field Study of Crawford Market and Byculla Market

Abstract

This field study investigates the microeconomic pressures faced by fruit vendors operating in Mumbai's informal sector, focusing on how inflationary pressures, input cost escalation, and volatility in income shape the livelihoods of fruit vendors working in the informal sector. Primary data was gathered through questionnaires administered to ten fruit vendors at two prominent wholesale and retail markets in Mumbai; Crawford Market and Byculla Market. All ten respondents reported rising fruit purchase prices over the past year, with wholesale costs, transport, and rent identified as the primary drivers. While most vendors can pass on some costs to the consumers' end price, high price elasticity amongst lower income customers who also face inflationary pressures, limits this, compressing margins even as nominal incomes rise.

Seasonal income volatility, particularly during the monsoon, compounds these pressures, and vendors rely almost entirely on informal coping mechanisms given minimal access to formal credit or government welfare schemes. Despite universal bank account ownership and high UPI adoption, only two respondents had ever taken a business loan and few had heard of, let alone successfully received a PM SVANidhi benefit, pointing to a significant implementation gap. The study highlights systemic vulnerabilities in Mumbai's informal vending economy and recommends targeted policy action around input cost relief, streamlined credit access, and formalised space allocation for fruit vending.

Sr. No.	Topic	Page no.
1.	Introduction	7
2.	Literature Review	8
3.	Methodology and Field Methods	9
4.	Field Work and Observations	9
5.	Analysis and Discussion	11
6.	Conclusion	15
7.	References	16
8.	Appendix	17

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background

India's informal economy is one of the largest in the world, employing approximately 80-90% of the non agrarian workforce. Street vendors form a critical link in the urban food supply chain. In Mumbai, fruit vendors at wholesale markets like Crawford and Byculla Market serve thousands of consumers daily, many from lower income households who depend on these vendors for affordable fresh produce. These markets represent two distinct but interconnected layers of informal trade: Crawford Market as a historic South Mumbai wholesale hub, and Byculla Market as a neighbourhood distribution point for the working class.

India's CPI for food has seen persistent upward pressure, driven by supply chain disruptions, rising fuel costs, and monsoon variability. Unlike formal businesses that can hedge against inflation or have access to credit systems, informal vendors operating on paper thin margins, with next to no capital can take little action beyond reducing household expenditure or increasing prices to the end consumer. The COVID 19 pandemic further deepened these vulnerabilities. lockdowns culled footfall and supply chains, leaving many vendors without income.

1.2 Rationale

Despite the enormity of India's informal sector, granular field studies capturing the lived economic experience of street vendors remain relatively scarce. This project seeks to contribute primary data, gathered through vendor interviews, piecing together pieces of the informal economic puzzle. Understanding how vendors perceive and respond to inflationary pressures has concrete policy implications for the betterment of social welfare, particularly regarding schemes like PM SVANidhi that were tailor made for them.

1.3 Objectives

- To document the socioeconomic profile of fruit vendors at Crawford Market and Byculla Market.
- To analyse the impact of inflationary pressures on vendors' input costs, pricing behaviour, and, to a certain extent, household welfare.
- To examine seasonal income variation and identify its primary drivers.
- To assess vendors' access to credit, savings, and government welfare schemes.
- To draw policy conclusions for improving income stability in the informal vending sector.

Chapter 2: Literature Review

De Soto (2000), in his seminal work The Mystery of Capital, argued that informal actors are rational economic agents constrained not by lack of ability but by institutional barriers. These include lack of property rights, formal credit, and legal recognition. This perspective is directly applicable to this study of Mumbai's fruit vendors, many of whom operate without Hawker License and cannot access institutional credit or formal legislative support. The Street Vendors (Protection of Livelihood and Regulation of Street Vending) Act, 2014, was India's legislative attempt to address this recognition gap, but implementation has remained uneven, as we shall observe in the forthcoming chapters.

Traditional microeconomics postulates that rising input costs will raise prices or reduce output. But in informal competitive markets, consumer's high price elasticity of demand constrains this. Todaro and Smith (2015), documents how microenterprises in developing economies absorb significant portions of input cost shocks due to thin margins and competitive pressure, a dynamic central to, and consistent with this study's findings. Additionally, The Harris-Todaro model of rural-urban migration provides the theoretical foundation for understanding why many vendors have migrated to Mumbai; expected urban income, even in the informal sector, supersedes rural alternatives.

Access to credit is a critical determinant of microenterprise resilience. Through their analysis across developing countries using Randomized Controlled Trials, Banerjee and Duflo (2007) demonstrated that access to microcredit, even at moderate interest rates, can significantly improve microenterprise investment and income generation. In India, the PM SVANidhi scheme (launched 2020) was specifically designed to provide working capital loans to street vendors, with a starting credit limit of Rs. 10,000, up to Rs 50,000 for vendors who repay on time, free from collateral.

However, Datta and Mahajan (2012) documented significant barriers to formal financial inclusion among informal workers, including absence of formal address proof, literacy requirements for documentation, and lack of awareness about available schemes. These impediments mirror what vendors in this study reported when asked about government support. The advent of UPI as a digital payment system, represents a positive development, and the high adoption of UPI as a mode of payment among this study's respondents is a major step on the path to financial inclusion in the informal sector.

Chapter 3: Methodology and Field Methods

3.1 Research Question

How do inflationary pressures on input costs affect the income stability, pricing behaviour, and coping strategies of informal fruit vendors in Mumbai's Crawford Market and Byculla Market?

3.2 Design and Sampling

This study uses a structured 41 question questionnaire administered through direct interviews, supplemented by field observation. Respondents were selected through convenience sampling at both field sites, active fruit vendors willing to participate. The final sample comprised ten vendors, all male, reflecting the gender disparity of fruit vendors at both markets. The sample spans ages 26-54, experience levels of 1-40 years, five states of origin, and monthly incomes of Rs. 15,000-60,000, providing meaningful diversity within its size.

Interviews were conducted in Hindi. Quantitative variables (age, income, household size, years of experience) were tabulated and analysed descriptively. Key limitations of the study include, but are not limited to: A small sample size, convenience sampling bias, self reported income estimates subject to bias.

Chapter 4: Field Work and Observations

4.1 Respondent Profiles

Name	**Age**	**Origin**	**Yrs Vending**	**Monthly Income**	**Primary Income?**	**Stall Type**
Mohammad Taufik	34	Mumbai	20	Rs. 30,000	No (other business)	Fixed (moves in market)
Mohammad	54	Mumbai	40	Rs. 60,000	No (makes murraba)	Fixed
Mahesh	28	Solapur	6	Rs. 25,000	No (family business)	Fixed
Gohil	27	Mumbai	6	Rs. 28,000	Yes	Moving
Santosh Jaiswal	43	UP	12	Rs. 45,000	No	Moving (seasonal)
Saddam	33	Aurangabad	6	Rs. 40,000	Yes	Fixed

Vishwa Kumar	45	Bihar	11	Rs. 55,000	No	Moving
Abdul	26	Lucknow	5	Rs. 20,000	No	Fixed
Arun Singh	28	Delhi	1	Rs. 15,000	Yes	Fixed
Vinod	35	UP	7	Rs. 25,000	No	Fixed

4.2 Key Findings

4.2.1 Demographics and Migration

Of ten respondents, four were born in Mumbai, four were interstate migrants from UP, Bihar, Delhi, and Lucknow, and two were interstate migrants from Solapur and Aurangabad. Seeking urban opportunity was the predominant motivation for migration (five respondents), consistent with the Harris-Todaro migration model. A stark accommodation divide emerged where all four Mumbai born vendors owned their housing, while all six migrants stayed in rented accommodation. Households ranged from 1 to 5 members, with dependents of up to 3, indicating sizable household economic responsibility across the board.

4.2.2 Nature of Work

Experience ranged from 1 to 40 years. Only four vendors identified fruit vending as their sole primary income source; the remaining six supplemented with other activities, family businesses, and seasonal shifts in location. One such example that stood out was Mohammad, who used overripe produce to make Murabba, which he sold and distributed amongst members of the local community. Daily working hours ranged from 8 to 12 hours, with seven respondents working every day of the week. This demanding schedule shows the absence of protection that comes with formal employment: no paid leave, no sick days, no overtime.

4.2.3 Income Levels and Trends

Monthly incomes ranged from Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 60,000. Six respondents reported incomes increasing over the past two years, four reported income remaining the same, and none reported a decline. However, these increases must be taken with a grain of salt, as rising input costs take away improvements in real purchasing power.

Income Bracket	No. of Vendors	Income Trend
Rs. 15,000-Rs. 25,000	4	3 increased, 1 same
Rs. 26,000 -Rs. 35,000	2	1 increased, 1 same
Rs. 36,000-Rs. 60,000	4	3 increased, 1 same

4.3.4 Seasonal Income Variation

All ten respondents reported clear seasonal income patterns. The primary cycles were:

- Low income July-October (5 vendors): Monsoon rainfall reduces footfall, disrupts fruit supply, and damages perishable stock in transit, with fruit rotting/ripening faster.
- High income May-July: Mango season (2 vendors): Santosh Jaiswal followed seasonal mobility specifically to capitalise on mango demand peaks.
- High income December-Feb: strawberry season (2 vendors): Mahabaleshwar strawberries create a reliable spike in demand for vendors.
- High income March: citrus season (1 vendor): Saddam cited citrus fruits as his primary seasonal peak product.

4.3.5 Inflationary Pressures on Input Costs

Every respondent concurred that fruit purchase prices from wholesalers had risen over the past year. The most frequently cited input cost increases were wholesale fruit prices (5 vendors), transport costs (3 vendors), and stall rent (2 vendors). Seven vendors reported being able to raise selling prices, at least to some extent. Nevertheless, customer behavioural responses were a significant constraint. Seven respondents reported that higher prices affected demand, with customers buying smaller quantities, switching to cheaper fruits, or expecting discounts.

4.3.6 Household Impact

Inflationary pressures directly translated to household welfare effects. Five vendors reported reduced savings capacity, three reported lower overall disposable income, and two cited a rising cost of living as the primary impact. Only two higher income respondents reported no household impact of great significance, reinforcing that lower income vendors bear a disproportionate welfare burden from input cost inflation.

4.3.7 COVID-19: Impact and Recovery

Eight out of ten vendors reported significant income disruption during the pandemic. Six of those eight had recovered to pre-pandemic levels. Structural changes in customer behaviour, an expectation of discounts, lower footfall norms appear to have persisted beyond the acute pandemic period, suggesting a demand-side shift that continues to affect vendor pricing power.

4.3.8 Financial Inclusion, Credit, and Government Schemes

All ten respondents held bank accounts and reported using UPI or QR code payment systems, indicating high basic financial infrastructure penetration. However, productive financial inclusion remained shallow: only two respondents had taken business loans (one from a bank, one via informal borrowing), and five reported being unable to save regularly. Regarding government schemes, six respondents had heard of relevant programmes (three specifically mentioning PM SVANidhi), but only three had applied, and none had successfully received a benefit. Lack of information (6 respondents) and documentation difficulties (2 respondents) were the primary barriers cited.

Chapter 5: Analysis and Discussion

5.1 Cost Push Inflation and Margin Erosion

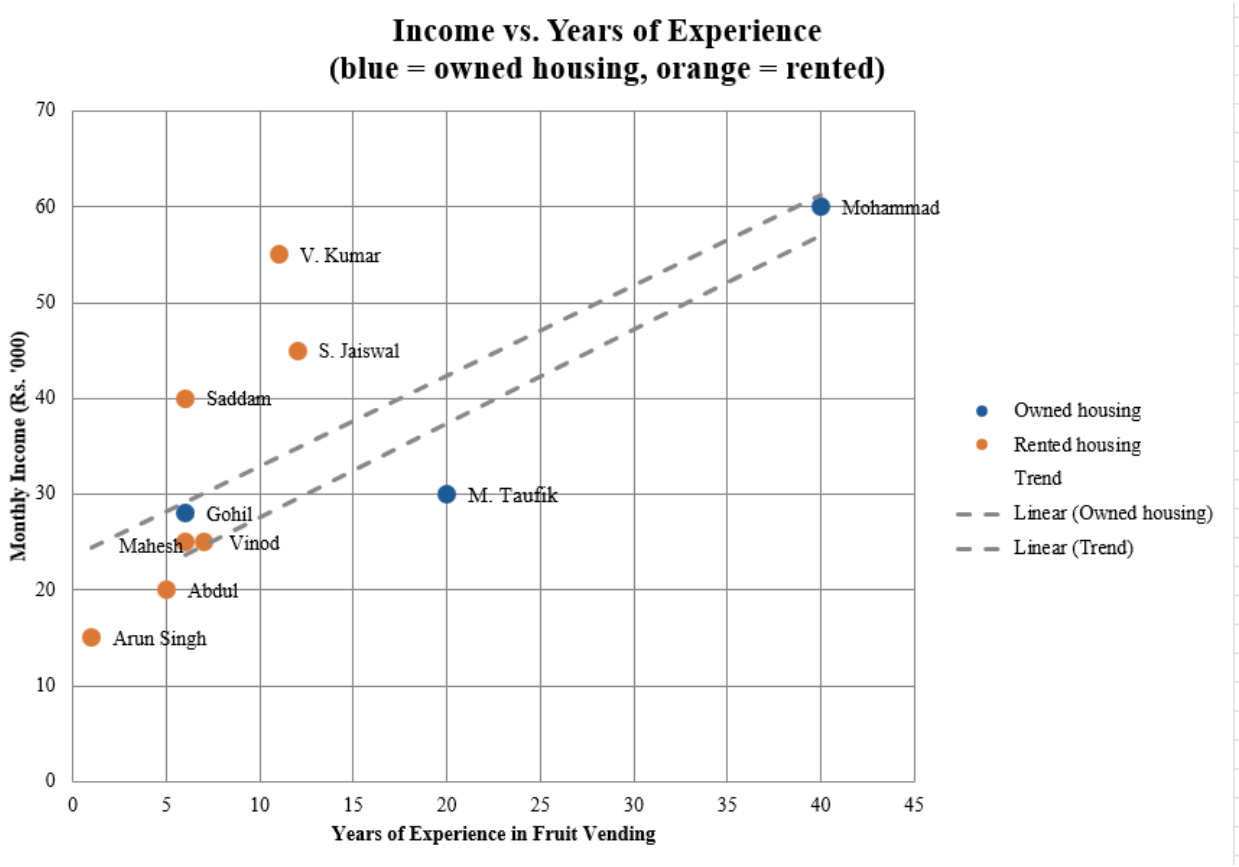
The confirmation of rising input costs across the board, points to textbook cost push inflation, where we see price increases originate on the supply side rather than from excess consumer demand. In standard microeconomic terms, a rise in the cost of inputs shifts the firm's short run supply curve to the left, meaning vendors must charge higher prices simply to maintain the same profit margin at any given level of output.

However, the extent to which vendors can recover these costs through higher selling prices depends critically on the price elasticity of demand for their goods. Fruits have relatively elastic demand among low income urban consumers, meaning that a given percentage rise in price leads to a more than proportionate fall in quantity demanded. This was directly shown in the responses where customers switched to cheaper alternatives, bought in smaller quantities, or resorted to bargaining when prices rose. In economic terms, vendors face a demand constraint that prevents them from fully restoring their profit margins through price increases alone.

The consequence is an erosion in profit margins. The gap between revenue per unit and cost per unit thins, even as nominal income may appear to be rising. To compensate, vendors must increase total output or labour input just to maintain the same profit. The prevalence of 10-12 hour, seven day work weeks across the sample is a direct manifestation of this; in the absence of formal wage protections or the ability to scale capital, labour input becomes the only avenue for adjustment. As Todaro and Smith (2015) note, this is a key feature of informal microenterprises in developing economies, where the brunt of macroeconomic shock is borne by the worker, their time, and physical effort as compared to a broader institutional or market buffer.

5.2 Income Heterogeneity and Its Drivers

The income gap between the highest (Rs. 60,000) and lowest earners (Rs. 15,000) within the same sector, city, and even some of the same markets raise an important question regarding income determination within informal vending. Three factors appear significant from this data:



Mohammad's Rs. 60,000 income after 40 years reflects long standing supplier relationships, product knowledge, and customer loyalty that newer entrants cannot replicate. His entrepreneurial pivot into murraba production represents the kind of product diversification that develops over decadal market entrenchment. Arun Singh, with one year of experience and the lowest income, is at the beginning of this learning curve.

Vendors supplementing vending with other activities, like seasonal mobility, a family business, or food processing, consistently appear at the higher end of the income distribution. Santosh Jaiswal's deliberate seasonal mobility strategy (shifting locations to follow seasonal supply peaks eg. mango), is seen as one such avenue that vendors use to effectively abate revenue volatility through product and location diversity.

All Mumbai vendors own their housing; all migrants pay rent. In Mumbai's housing market, rent costs can consume Rs. 4,000-10,000 or more per month, a structural overhead cost that migrant vendors have no choice but to bear. This systematically disadvantages migrants, who also tend to have weaker supplier and customer networks compared to long established local vendors.

5.3 Seasonal Vulnerability and Risk Coping

The July-October monsoon period represents a cyclical income crisis for the majority of respondents. Even vendors with adequate average annual income experience significant welfare losses due to the uneven distribution of earnings. With less accessibility to formal savings products, insurance, or credit specifically designed for seasonal shortfalls, vendors rely on informal mechanisms, reduced household consumption, and informal borrowing.

Notably, two vendors engage in a rational cost minimizing strategy, travelling back to their home states during slow periods, thus reducing Mumbai's high costs of living during periods of low income. However, the opportunity cost of this strategy forfeits sales maximization, whereby vendors forgeo market opportunities that may arise in their absence. This trade off illustrates how the lack of formal income mechanisms forces difficult choices that are rational yet suboptimal.

5.4 The PM SVANidhi Implementation Gap

Perhaps the most striking finding of this study is the zero success rate in PM SVANidhi benefit receipt despite three applicants. The scheme was tailor made for workers in the informal sector. Working capital loans starting at Rs 10,000, with digital payment incentives and graduated credit tranches up to Rs. 50,000 for on time repayers, all free from collateral. In principle, all respondents who had heard of it should have been eligible to reap the rewards.

The bureaucratic red tape in the form of documentation requirements, lack of information, and incomplete municipal vendor surveys that constrain scheme eligibility reflect what Banerjee and Duflo (2007) identify as the "last mile" of financial inclusivity, where bank accounts and relevant infrastructure exist, yet the transactional, bureaucratic, and administrative cost of converting these into productive financial access remain prohibitively high, and pose barriers to entry for many an informal worker. The fact that only six of ten vendors were even aware of the scheme, and that three applicants received nothing, suggests a significant gap between policy intent and ground level implementation that severely limits the scheme's welfare impact in these markets, and is a classic example of information asymmetry and red tape culminating in a policy implementation gap.

Chapter 6: Conclusion and Recommendations

6.1 Conclusion

This study set out to investigate how inflationary cost pressures affect income stability and coping strategies among informal fruit vendors in Mumbai. Across all the ten respondents, a picture is painted where rising wholesale prices, rent, and transport costs, narrow margins in a perfectly competitive, price sensitive market environment. Nominal increases in income mask real margin erosion, as vendors are unable to fully pass costs on to the end consumer without sacrificing demand. Seasonal income volatility, particularly due to the monsoon, compounds this pressure, and the lack of access to formal credit and welfare systems leaves vendors no choice but to circumnavigate around these shocks through informal and suboptimal coping strategies.

The structural vulnerability of migrant vendors (six out of ten respondents) is a common theme. Higher accommodation costs, weaker local networks, and greater insecurity in their employment of fruit vending as a livelihood place migrants at a consistent income disadvantage relative to vendors born in Mumbai. This has direct implications for how welfare policy should be designed and targeted, with intra and interstate migrants in mind as well.

Despite encouraging signals like universal bank account ownership and UPI adoption, financial inclusion remains a problem. The PM SVANidhi gap (zero successful applicants out of three who applied) is emblematic of a broader implementation failure that renders well designed policy largely ineffective at the vendor level.

6.2 Recommendations

- **Simplify PM SVANidhi access:** Mobile based apps, community registration drives, and reduced documentation requirements could dramatically improve uptake.
- **Subsidised collective procurement:** Municipal authorities could facilitate collective buying arrangements among vendors, which are analogous to farmer producer organisations, to reduce wholesale input cost pressure through pooled purchasing power.
- **Formalise vending space allocation:** Full implementation of the Street Vendors Act (2014) including designated vending zones and localized committees in Mumbai would reduce the insecurity that underlies many of the economic vulnerabilities that informal vendors face.
- **Seasonal credit products:** Given its cyclical nature, the monsoon income dips are predictable, short term seasonal credit access or cooperative savings mechanisms within markets like Crawford and Byculla could significantly reduce the welfare cost of income variability.
- **Targeted financial literacy outreach:** Regular, localized information sessions on scheme eligibility, digital savings products, and application procedures would address the gap in information that six of ten respondents cited as their primary barrier to welfare access.

6.3 Final Reflection

This field study offers a valuable, boots-on-ground perspective on the economic realities that aggregate inflation statistics often obscure. Behind every macroeconomic variable, every percentage point rise in the food CPI, are vendors like those at Crawford Market and Byculla Market. They stay afloat in a sea of cost pressures and thin margins, navigating seasonal hardship without formal safety nets, and sustaining household livelihoods through long hours and adaptive entrepreneurial ingenuity. Effective economic policy for the informal sector must be grounded in a granular understanding of how macroeconomic forces translate into lived microeconomic experience.

References:

Banerjee, A. V., & Duflo, E. (2007). The economic lives of the poor. *Journal of Economic Perspectives, 21*(1), 141–167. https://doi.org/10.1257/jep.21.1.141

Soto, H. D. (2000). *The-mystery-of-capital.pdf*. The Mystery Of Capital. https://yendieu.files.wordpress.com/2009/04/the-mystery-of-capital.pdf

Harris, J. R., & Todaro, M. P. (1970). Migration, unemployment and development: A two-sector analysis. *American Economic Review, 60*(1), 126–142. https://www.jstor.org/stable/1807860

Hart, K. (1973). Informal income opportunities and urban employment in Ghana. *The Journal of Modern African Studies, 11*(1), 61–89. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0022278X00008089

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Government of India. (2020). *PM Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) scheme guidelines*. MoHUA. https://pmsvanidhi.mohua.gov.in

National Commission for Enterprises in the Unorganised Sector. (2007). *Report on conditions of work and promotion of livelihoods in the unorganised sector*. Government of India. https://labour.gov.in/sites/default/files/nceus_report_on_conditions_of_work_and_promotion_of_livelihood_in_the_unorganised_sector.pdf

Reserve Bank of India. (2023). *Annual report 2022–23*. RBI. https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/AnnualReportPublications.aspx

Todaro, M. P., & Smith, S. C. (2015). *Economic development* (12th ed.). Pearson Education.

Appendix:

Responses:

Name	Age	Gender	ighest level of educatio	y members in H	Dependents	place of birth	hany years in m	ason for migrat	living situation	many years wo	s fruit vending primary so
Mohammad Ta	34	M	8th	4	2	Mumbai	34	N/a	Owned	20	Does other business
Mohammad	54	M	10th	5	3	Mumbai	54	N/a	Owned	40	makes murraba in commu
Mahesh	28	M	9th	4	2	Solapur	4	Family-related	Rented	6	other family business
Gohil	27	M	4th	2	2	Mumbai	27	N/A	Owned	6	yes
Santosh Jaiswa	43	M	BA	4	3	UP	15	Employment	Rented	12	no-
Saddam	33	M	12th	3	3	Aurangabad	6	Employment	Rented	6	yes
Vishwa Kumar	45	M	6th	3	2	Bihar	18	Employment	Rented	11	no-
Abdul	26	M	9th	1	1	Lucknow	7	Employment	Rented	5	no-
Arun Singh	28	M	10th	2	2	Delhi	3	Employment	Rented	1	yes
Vinod	35	M	10th	4	2	UP	10	Employment	Rented	7	no-

s fruit vending primary source of income?	Fixed or moving location?	verage working hours per da	o you work every day of the week	pproximate monthly incom	come change in last 2 years (Increase/D
Does other business	fixed, moves within the mark	8	Yes	30k	increase
makes murraba in community/byculla lo	fixed	8	No	60k	increase
other family business	fixed	12	Yes	25k	same
yes	moving	10	No	28k	same
no-	moving with seasons	9	Yes	45k	increase
yes	fixed	12	Yes	40k	increase
no-	moving	8	No	55k	same
no-	fixed	12	No	20k	increase
yes	fixed	12	No	15k	increase
no-	fixed	10	No	25k	same

easonal income variation?	easons for income chang	Periods unable to work?	ave fruit purchase prices increased	Which input costs increased most	ble to increase selling price	igher prices affect
low income july-oct	rainfall	higher costs of fruits during seasc	yes	transport	yes	yes
low income july-oct	rainfall	illness	yes	wholesale fruits	yes	no
high income in december	fruit in season(strawberry	travel back home	yes	rent	to some extent	yes
low income july-oct	rainfall	changing costs	yes	wholesale fruits	yes	yes
high income in may-july	fruit in season(mango)	travel back home	yes	wholesale fruits	to some extent	no
high income in march	fruit in season(citrus)	illness	yes	transport costs	yes	somewhat
high income in may-july	fruit in season(mango)	illness	yes	wholesale fruits	to some extent	somewhat
low income july-oct	rainfall	travel back home	yes	rent	to some extent	yes
high income in december	fruit in season (strawberr	travel back home	yes	transport costs	yes	yes
low income july-oct	rainfall	none	yes	rent	yes	yes

mpact on household expense	ffected during COVID-19	ncome returned to pre-pandemic levels	hange in customer behaviour	urrent business uncertaintie	have a bank ac	se digital payments (UPI/QR)
lesser savings	yes	yes	expect discounts	rising prices	Yes	yes
none	yes	yes	want more variation	rising prices	Yes	yes
lower disposable income	yes	no	lower footfall	customer demand	Yes	yes
lesser savings	no	no	expect discounts	selling stock	Yes	yes
none	yes	yes	want more variation	rising prices	Yes	yes
cost of living	yes	yes	no	selling stock	Yes	yes
lesser savings	yes	yes	want more variation	customer demand	Yes	yes
lower disposable income	no	no	no	selling stock	Yes	yes
lower disposable income	no	no	lower footfall	customer demand	Yes	yes
cost of living	yes	somewhat	expect discounts	rising prices	Yes	yes

Taken loan for business	Loan source	Able to save regularly	Aware of government schemes	Which schemes?	Applied for government benefit	eceived benefit	ifficulties accessing government suppo
no	-	No	No	-	No	No	lack of info
yes	bank	yes	Yes	PM SVANidhi	yes	no	documentation issues
no	-	No	No	-	No	No	lack of info
no	-	No	no	-	No	No	lack of info
yes	informal borrowin	Yes	No	-	Yes	no	documentation issues
no	-	Yes	Yes	-	No	No	lack of info
no	-	no	Yes	PM SVANidhi	No	No	lack of info
no	-	Yes	No	-	No	No	lack of info
no	-	No	No	-	No	No	lack of info
no	-	No	No	-	No	No	lack of info

eceived benefit	ifficulties accessing government suppo	Main work challenges	Support needed for income stability
No	lack of info	Rising costs	lower input costs
no	documentation issues	work hours	access to credit
No	lack of info	unstable income	secure vending space
No	lack of info	unstable income	secure vending space
no	documentation issues	rising costs	Lower input costs
No	lack of info	work hours	access to credit
No	lack of info	rising costs	Lower input costs
No	lack of info	unstable income	secure vending space
No	lack of info	unstable income	secure vending space
No	lack of info	work hours	Lower input costs







